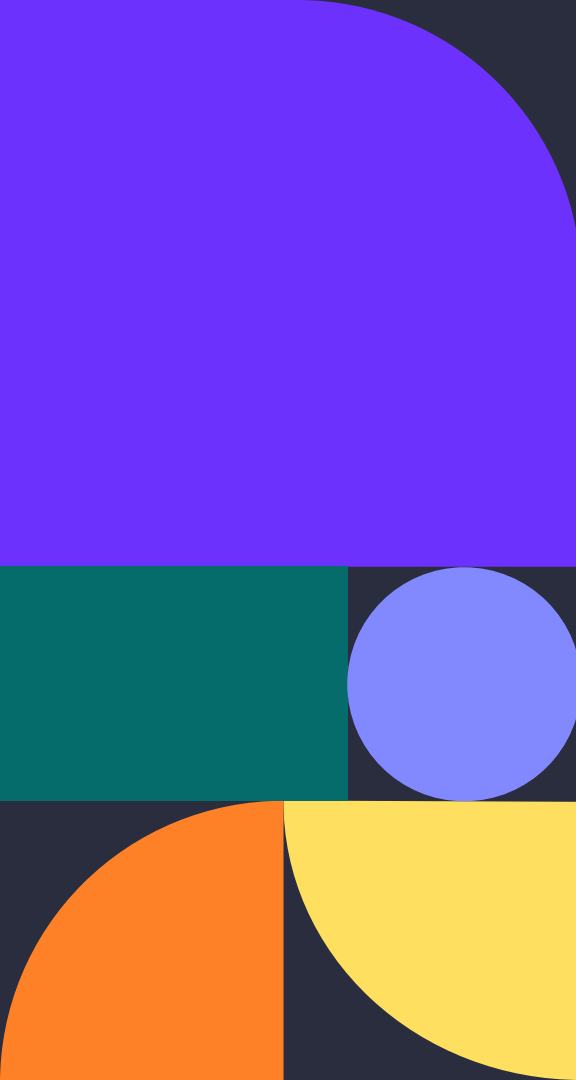




UX Day 1 **Competitive Analysis**

What is a competitive analysis?

In a competitive analysis, a usability expert takes an in-depth look at a series of related products. The expert is looking for relative strengths and weaknesses, trends, patterns, and differences.

Looking at similar content across several designs can reveal holes in your content or functionality; holes in others' products may inspire an addition to your product.



Direct vs. Indirect analysis

While **Direct** analysis involves looking at your competitors to see what they are doing well, and what you may be able to do better, **Indirect** or **parallel** analysis involves viewing similar applications that may not be in competition with your app.

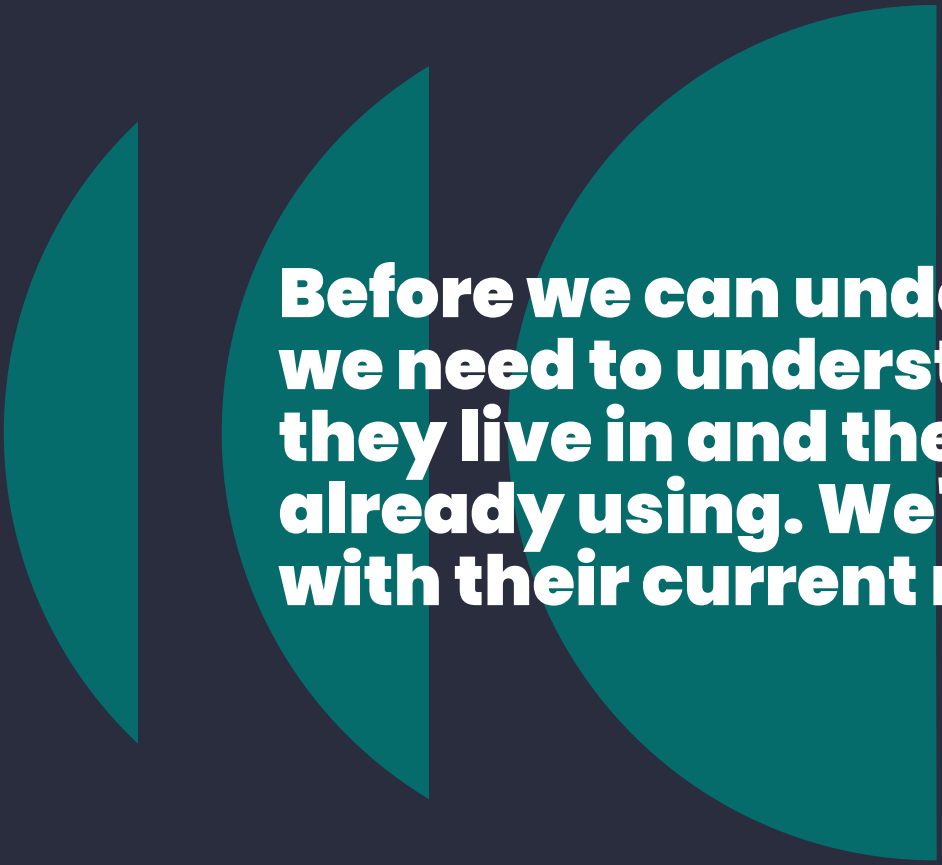
By looking at an app that has similar functionality to what you are trying to achieve, you can often gain valuable insight, and in some cases find a creative way to solve a problem that your competitors may have overlooked.

How does competitive analysis fit into the design process?

We are at the beginning of the process in the **understand** stage.

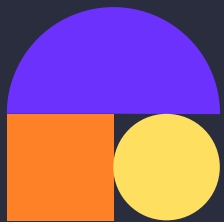
This part of the process helps us to understand and empathize with the user.



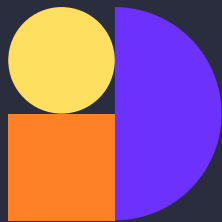


**Before we can understand our users,
we need to understand the world
they live in and the tools they are
already using. We're empathizing
with their current reality.**

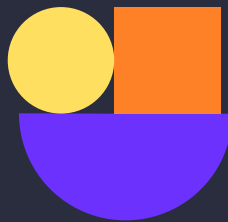
What to look for in your competitive analysis



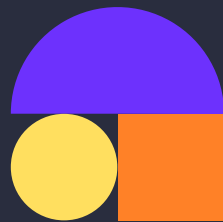
**Key
Features**



**Unique
Decisions**



**User
Flows**



**Strengths &
Weaknesses**

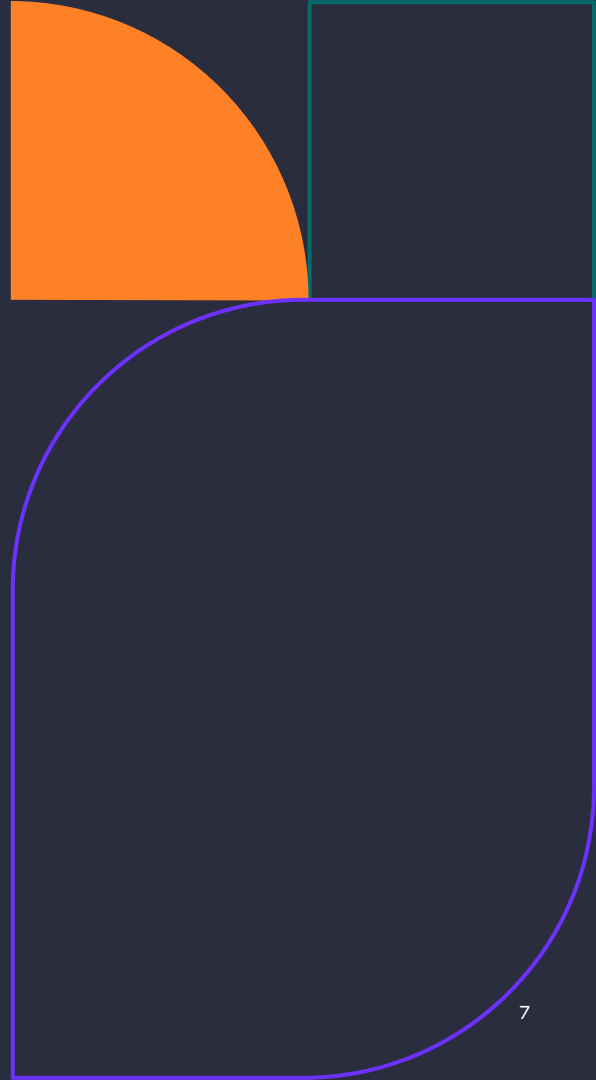


Let's Compare:

Airbnb vs. Hilton

Things to observe include:

- Search and filtering
- Property pages
- Booking flow
- Trust building



 Search for a destination

 Check-in
Add dates

 Check-out
Add dates

 1 room, 1 guest

 Special rates

Find a hotel



All



Homes



Experiences



Services

Where
Search destinations

When
Add dates

Who
Add guests

 Search

Suggested destinations



Nearby
Find what's around you



Gatlinburg, TN
For sights like
Great Smoky Mountains National Park



Hocking Hills State Park, OH
Popular destination



Cincinnati, OH
Near you



Red River Gorge, KY
Popular destination



Columbus, OH
Great for a weekend getaway



Nashville, TN
For sights like Ryman Auditorium

Popular homes in Gatlinburg



Cabin in Gatlinburg
\$716 for 2 nights • ★ 4.96



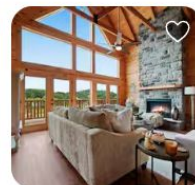
Home in Gatlinburg
\$612 for 2 nights • ★ 4.96

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Home in Sevierville
\$672 for 2 nights • ★ 5.0

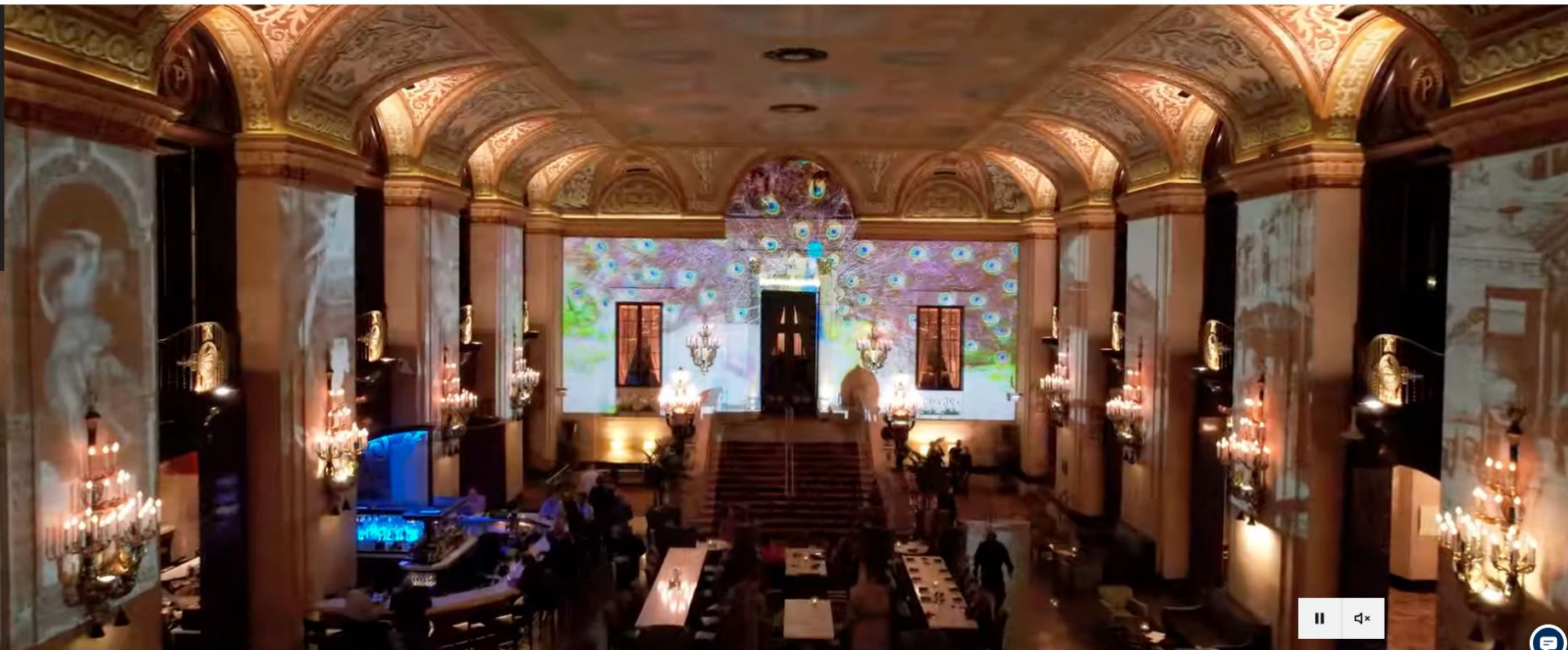
 20 Aug 2026 / 21 Aug 2026

 1 room, 1 guest

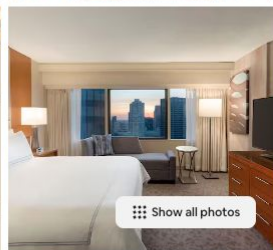
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Room Filters

Special rates



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12 rooms found. **6 are currently sold out.** We're showing the average price per night.

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USD - US Dollar



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- Workspace

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- Minibar
- Workspace

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- Minibar
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Next

Assignment 1

Competitive Analysis



Purpose



Practice to learn and understand competitive analysis



Learn and apply early-stage UX research skills



Prepare for heuristic evaluation later in this course

Description

Perform the following tasks

01. Choose 2 apps or websites similar to your app idea

02. Research features, user flows, UI patterns, and standout design elements

03. Use the worksheet to write notes about your research

04. Upload the worksheet to the Dropbox on Pilot



VERY IMPORTANT! Review for next Class:

USER FLOWS

- **90 Second User Flow**
 - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Zt2GmDOEHM0>
- **What is a User Flow?**
 - <https://youtu.be/PTrbSSMhsqE?si=VP-m2lzIPRBuQ8kv>
- **User Flows 101 (Disclaimer: The BEST video, but easily the most boring)**
 - https://youtu.be/fhhEwu9SqtI?si=IWxe_CSqbQ026Mzj

WIREFRAMES

- **What is a wireframe?**
 - <https://youtu.be/CskJV6pBthM?si=uhF4SayCJMIWYear>
- **Creating Low Fidelity Wireframes in Figma**
 - <https://youtu.be/vplB-w--sao?si=KbhtVFAhQXARBSY2>

Next Class Agenda

**01. Review Competitive Analysis in
small groups**

02. Discussion and Lecture

**03. Workshop user flows and
wireframes**



Questions?

Thank you!

